



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times

PEOPLE take part in a vigil for Alex Pretti, who was fatally shot by federal agents in Minneapolis on Saturday.

HOMAN OUTLINES DEMANDS FOR A ROLLBACK

Pulling agents out of Minnesota depends on state ‘cooperation,’ he says in a visit.

By JENNY JARVIE

President Trump’s border policy advisor, Tom Homan, said Thursday that federal authorities would wind down immigration crackdowns in Minnesota only if agents were given access to jails to seize undocumented immigrants for deportation.

Speaking to reporters publicly for the first time since arriving in Minnesota on Monday after federal agents fatally shot two U.S. citizens during immigration operations, Homan suggested it could be a while before the Trump administration pulls agents out of Minneapolis.

“The withdrawal of law enforcement resources here is dependent upon cooperation,” Homan said Thursday. “As we see that cooperation happen, then the redeployment will happen.”

Homan, whom Trump deployed to Minnesota this week to bring down the political temperature after Border Patrol agents fatally shot Alex Pretti on a Minneapolis street, said the federal government was not backing down from its aggressive immigration agenda.

“We are not surrendering our mission at all,” he said. “We are not surrendering the president’s mission of immigration enforcement. Let’s make that clear.”

Homan’s focus on jails is not a new position for the Trump administration. He and other senior officials have long argued they would not be targeting immigrants in communities in Democratic-led cities if local officials allowed federal immigration officers access to their jails.

On Saturday, the day federal immigration agents shot Pretti, U.S. Atty. Gen. Pam Bondi sent a letter to Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz saying he could “bring an end to the chaos” in his state by, among other things, repealing “sanctuary city” policies and allowing federal agents into local jails.

Data from last year show that Republican-led states, such as Texas and Florida, have higher arrest numbers of immigrants than Democratic-led states, particularly when measured against population. That’s because they have a longer history of working directly with U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and are more [See **Homan**, A6]

More arrests in L.A. as U.S. agents work faster

Activists rethink response to aggressive enforcement

By Ruben Vives, Karen Garcia and Hailey Wang

At a recent training session for 300 immigration activists in Los Angeles, the main topic was Minnesota and the changes to federal immigration tactics.

For the last few months, federal law enforcement officers have intensified their efforts to locate and deport immigrants suspected of living in the country illegally. They have used children as bait, gone door to door and at times stormed into people’s homes without judicial warrants.

But it was the fatal shootings of Renee Good and Alex Pretti, two U.S. citizens protesting immigration raids in Minnesota, that sparked a growing backlash of the federal government’s aggressive ac-

tions and caused activists to reconsider their own approach when monitoring Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

“One quick note about de-escalation,” Joseline Garcia, the community defense director for City Council District 1, told a crowd at St. Paul’s Commons in Echo Park. “What we would do when it came to de-escalation is we’d tell people their rights, try to get their information and try to reason with the ICE agents and pressure them to leave.”

“Things have changed a ton in the past two months, so that’s not something we’re willing to put you all at risk to do,” she added. “There is risk here and we are [See **Los Angeles**, A7]

Schiff, Padilla leading effort to rein in ICE

Senators help reach deal to buy more time for changes to agency and avoid shutdown.

By KEVIN RECTOR, ANA CEBALLOS AND SEEMA MEHTA

California Democrats have assumed leading roles in their party’s counteroffensive to the Trump administration’s massive immigration crackdown — seizing on a growing sense, shared by some Republicans, that the campaign has gotten so out of hand that the political winds have shifted heavily in their favor.

They stalled Department of Homeland Security funding in the Senate and pushed the impeachment of Secretary Kristi Noem in the House. They strategized against a threatened move by President Trump to invoke the Insurrection Act and challenged administration policies and street tactics in federal court. And they have shown up in Minneapolis to express outrage and demanded Department of Justice records following two fatal shootings of U.S. citizens there.

The push comes at an extremely tense moment, as Minneapolis and the nation reel from the fatal weekend shooting of Alex Pretti, and served as an impetus for a spending deal reached late Thursday between Senate Democrats and the White House to avert another partial government shutdown.

The compromise would allow lawmakers to fund large parts of the federal government while giving them more time to negotiate new restrictions for immigration agents.

“This is probably one of the few windows on immigration specifically where Democrats find themselves on offense,” said Mike Madrid, a California Republican political consultant. “It is a rare and extraordinary moment.”

Both of the state’s Democratic senators, Adam Schiff and Alex Padilla, came out in staunch opposition to the latest Homeland Security funding measure in Congress, vowing to block it unless the administration scales back its street operations and reins in masked agents who have killed Americans in multiple shootings, clashed with protesters and provoked communities with aggressive tactics.

Under the agreement reached Thursday, the Department of Homeland Security will be funded for two weeks — a period that in theory will allow lawmakers to negotiate guardrails for the federal agency. The measure still will need to be approved by the House, though it is not clear when they will hold a vote — meaning a short shutdown still could occur even if the Senate deal is accepted.

Padilla negotiated with the White House to separate the controversial measures in question — to provide \$64.4 billion for Homeland Security and \$10 billion spe-

[See **Senate deal**, A7]

Sealing back in Maine: Sen. Susan Collins says ICE will end all major operations in her state. **NATION**, A5

Venezuela’s affordability crisis deepens

Trump has promised economic revival, but many say life after Maduro is worse.

By MERY MOGOLLÓN AND PATRICK J. McDONNELL

CARACAS, Venezuela — Oswaldo Pinto is accustomed to disappointments during shopping excursions to buy food for his family. But he was especially demoralized the other day after scouring for bargains at the sprawling Coche Market,



ANDREA HERNÁNDEZ BRICEÑO For The Times

“EVERYTHING has just become too expensive,” one Venezuelan man said. Above, a shopper in Caracas.

which serves a mostly working-class clientele on the southern fringes of this chaotic capital.

“This month I could only buy half of what I needed,” said Pinto, 41, a taxi driver and father of two, including a new baby at home. “Everything has just become too expensive. The prices are rising very quickly. Only meat is a bit cheaper now — but I can’t afford that either.”

His meager purchases in hand, Pinto left the market. Across the street from the exit, a mural blares a message of defiance:

[See **Venezuela**, A4]

FBI raid revives false 2020 assertions

By NICHOLAS RICCARDI

Donald Trump lost his bid for reelection in 2020. But for more than five years, he’s been trying to convince Americans the opposite is true by falsely saying the election was marred by widespread fraud.

Now that he’s president again, Trump is pushing the federal government to back up those bogus claims.

On Wednesday, the FBI served a search warrant at the election headquarters of Fulton County, Ga., which includes most of Atlanta, seeking ballots from the 2020 election. That follows Trump’s comments earlier this month when he suggested during a speech at the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, that charges related to the election were imminent.

“The man has obsessions, as do a fair number of people, but he’s the only one who has the full power of the United States behind him,” said Rick Hasen, a UCLA law professor.

Hasen and many others noted that Trump’s use of the FBI to pursue his obsession with the 2020 election is part of a pattern of the president transforming the federal government into his personal tool of vengeance.

Sen. Jon Ossoff, a Georgia Democrat, compared the search to the Minnesota immigration crackdown that has killed two U.S. citizen protesters, launched by Trump as his latest blow against the state’s governor, who ran against him as Vice President Kamala Harris’ running mate in 2024.

“From Minnesota to Georgia, on display to the whole world, is a President [See **Raid**, A6]

County to pause some sex abuse payouts

Delay of settlement funds comes amid fraud inquiries, putting plaintiffs in limbo.

By REBECCA ELLIS

Los Angeles County will halt some payments from its \$4-billion sex abuse settlement, leaving many plaintiffs on edge as prosecutors

ramp up an investigation into allegations of fraud.

L.A. County agreed last spring to the record payout to settle a flood of lawsuits from people who said they’d been sexually abused by staff in government-run foster homes and juvenile camps. Many attorneys had told their clients they could expect the first tranche of money to start flowing this month.

But the county’s acting

chief executive officer, Joseph M. Nichitta, said Thursday that the county would “pause all payments” for unvetted claims after a request by Dist. Atty. Nathan Hochman. These are claims that have been flagged as requiring a “higher level of scrutiny,” according to a joint report submitted Thursday by attorneys in the settlement.

The district attorney announced he would investi-

gate the historic settlement after reporting by The Times that found some plaintiffs who said they were paid to sue. Investigators have found “a significant number of cases where we believe there is potential fraud,” according to a spokesperson for the prosecutor’s office. The State Bar is spearheading a separate inquiry into fraud allegations.

[See **Settlement**, A12]

Democrat joins race for governor

San José Mayor Matt Mahan, a critic of Gov. Gavin Newsom, enters the fray. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

A look at Rams’ bittersweet year

What went right? What went wrong? And what might their offseason plans be? **SPORTS**, B10

Weather

Very warm.
L.A. Basin: 84/58. **B6**

First lady’s rocky movie rollout

Global hostility and national strife greet the new “Melania” film doc. **ENTERTAINMENT**, E1

Markets **A12**
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GODOFREDO A. VÁSQUEZ Associated Press

XAVIER SMITH’S muff of a punt helped end the Rams’ season in NFC title game loss to Seattle.